often wore flimsy summer outfits, were poorly shod, and shouldered one-shot bolt-action rifles). Finally, the Chinese used battle-hardened veterans of the Korean war whereas the last time Indian forces had truly fought a war was in 1947–48 against Pakistan. Few of those Indian troops would have been in the military in 1962.

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The war ended on 21 November 1962 when China declared a unilateral ceasefire. The terms on which it ended were outlined by the Chinese on 24 October in their original ceasefire proposal (repeated on 21 November). Essentially, the Chinese proposed that the dispute be settled by negotiation and that, pending a settlement, both sides respect the Line of Actual Control and disengage forces by withdrawing to a point twenty kilometres behind the LAC as it existed on 7 November 1959. In the eastern sector, this meant the McMahon Line and in the western and middle sectors it meant the traditional customary line which the Chinese had insisted on in their claims. India's acceptance of China's proposal was de facto in the sense that the Indian Army refrained from crossing the 1962 line in the eastern sector and the 1959 line in the western sector.

The Border, Tibet, and Military Relations, 1963–Present

After the war, the two sides gradually normalized relations, eventually returned to border negotiations, largely avoided quarrelling over Tibet, and instituted a series of confidence-building measures that contributed to military stability. Yet in the end they failed to resolve the border quarrel, found themselves periodically at odds over Tibet, and from 2013 were involved in a series of military confrontations. The climax to this period of failed cooperation was less spectacular than in 1962. The melee at Galwan in June 2020 did not escalate to outright hostilities, but the threat of real fighting loomed large. We see here a repeat of the period between 1949 and